Social Media Content Analysis Report

MKT 7150-01- Viral Marketing and Social Media

Kunal Swani

Group 4

Sushant Bhatta

Priya Kothamasu

Amna Nawaz

Mitakshi Patel

Sai Pranaya Ramireddy

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Introduction

In today's digital age, social media has become an integral tool for universities to engage with their audience, promote events, share achievements, and attract prospective students. Facebook and Instagram are two of the most popular platforms for universities to connect with their community and showcase their campus life, academic excellence, and student achievements. Understanding how a university's social media presence compares to that of its competitors can provide valuable insights into its outreach efforts and effectiveness in engaging its audience.

In this analysis, we'll compare the social media posts of Wright State University with Ohio State University on both Facebook and Instagram over the last 30 days (about 4 and a half weeks). We'll examine key metrics such as post frequency, engagement rates, content types, and audience interaction to gain a comprehensive understanding of their respective social media strategies.

Did you notice any trends across the competitor and WSU? Are there differences and/or similarities?

The Ohio State University

Facebook Post Trends:

At Ohio State University, non-promotional image posts emerged as a consistent accomplishment, garnering high engagement across various metrics, including likes, shares, and comments. These posts were popular with the audience, demonstrating their popularity and efficacy in generating conversation. Furthermore, promotional videos emerged as a dominant category, notably in terms of total views, with an impressive 8400 views.

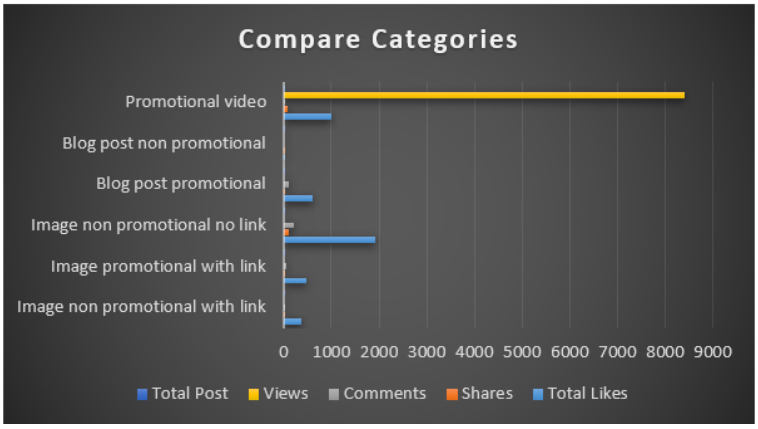


Figure A.1: OSU Facebook chart (2024)

Their popularity was further underscored by strong performance in post averages. Each day of the week revealed distinct capabilities, with Sundays appearing as the highest day for likes and comments, with an incredible 1299 likes and 196 comments respectively. Thursdays had the most views, with a total of 8400. Furthermore, Thursdays had the largest shares, showing strong interaction with the topic.

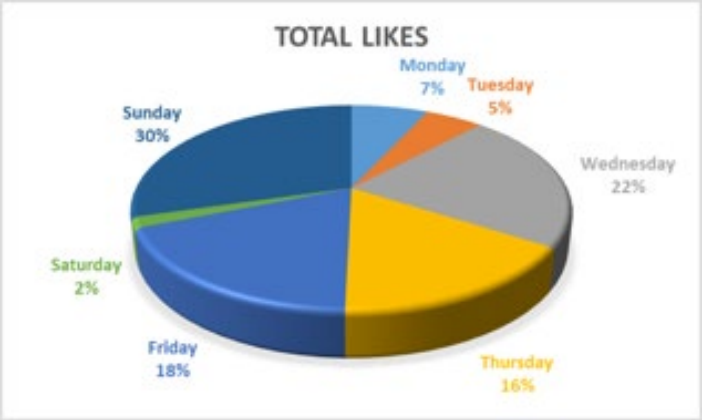


Figure A.2: OSU Facebook total daily likes (2024)

Additionally, ideal posting times were found, with afternoon slots, particularly 3 p.m., being positive for likes. However, 7 p.m. appeared to be the most effective time for generating comments. Interestingly, posts published at 12 p.m. received the most shares and views, demonstrating the importance of time in promoting engagement.

Figure A.3: OSU Facebook posting times (2024)

Instagram Post Trends:

On Instagram, promotional videos outperformed other content categories in terms of interaction metrics. They received the most likes, comments, and views, with an astonishing total of 55,930 likes, 730 comments, and 647,944 views across twelve posts.

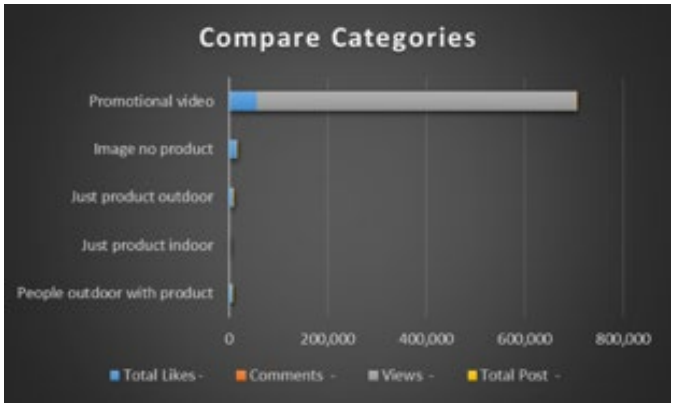


Figure A.4: OSU Instagram totals (2024)

Furthermore, posts containing "People Outdoor with Product" performed particularly well, receiving 4,988 average likes and 24 comments, demonstrating the significant impact of content categories on audience interaction. Furthermore, promotional videos remained the most popular, with an average of 53,995 views and 12 total posts.

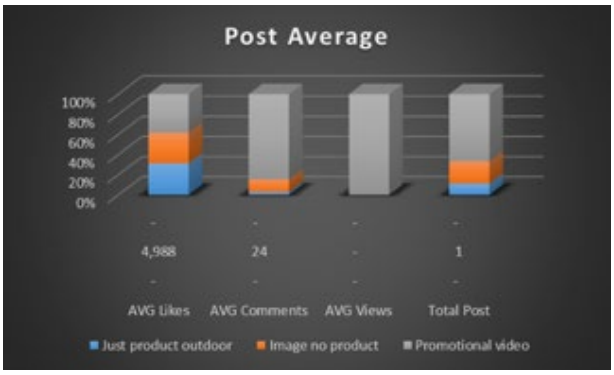


Figure A.5: OSU Instagram averages (2024)

Wright State University

Facebook Post Trends:

Promotional images with link posts have emerged as the best at Wright State University, regularly exceeding other content categories across multiple interaction measures. These posts receive the most likes 471, 30 shares, and 17 comments out of 25, suggesting their success in generating engagement. While promotional images with link posts are highly interactive, promotional videos lead in terms of total views, with an outstanding figure of 654 views demonstrating different user engagement preferences.

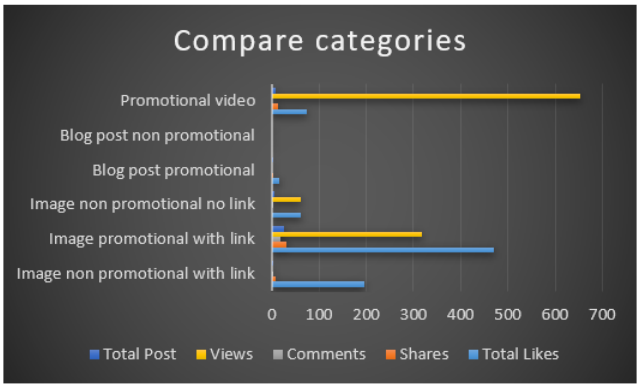


Figure B.1: WSU Facebook totals (2024)

Furthermore, post averages show that image non-promotional link postings perform particularly well, with an average of 99 likes, 5 shares, and 2 comments. Interestingly, image promotional link

postings have the highest average total posts of 25, emphasizing their importance in the university's social media strategy.

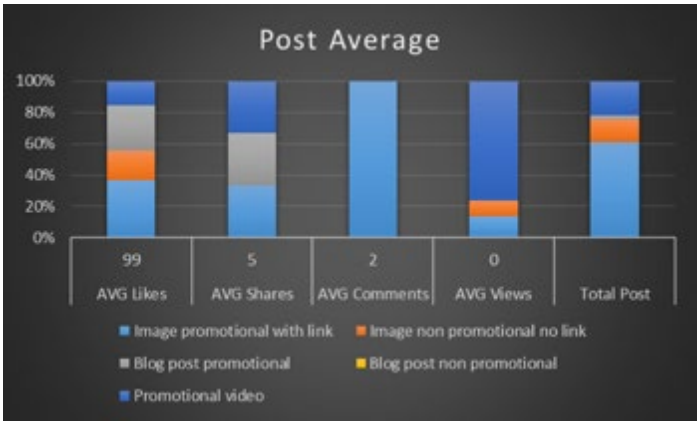


Figure B.2: WSU Facebook Averages (2024)

In terms of day of the week, Sundays are particularly great for likes, with significant engagement figures of 254. Mondays, on the other hand, perform well in views 401 despite reduced total involvement in terms of likes, shares, and comments.

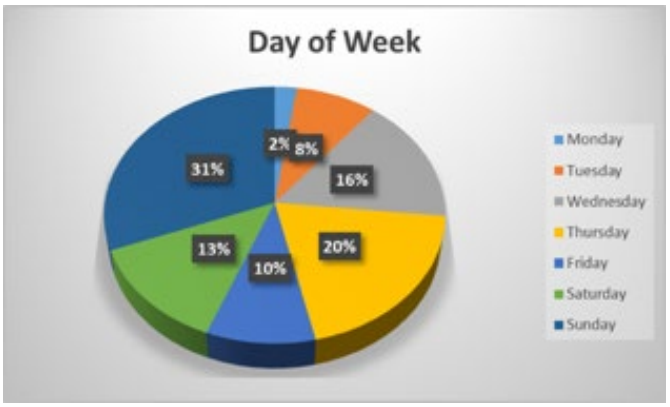


Figure B.3: WSU Facebook total daily likes (2024)

Additionally, evenings, particularly 7 p.m., are best posting times for increased likes, highlighting the significance of scheduling in optimizing engagement on social media platforms.

Instagram Post Trends:

Instagram content is dominated by promotional videos, which routinely outperform other content categories across multiple interaction metrics. These videos receive the most likes (2.488), 33 comments, and an incredible 25,986 views across 13 postings, demonstrating their popularity and efficacy in catching audience attention.

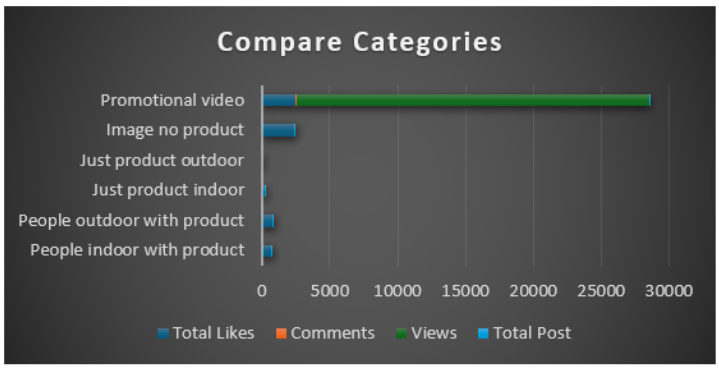


Figure B.4: WSU Instagram totals (2024)

Posts with "Image no Product" receive a high average of 297 likes, showing that users prefer this type of material. However, posts displaying only the product outdoors did not perform well in any category, indicating the need for more compelling content varieties. Despite differences in content, promotional videos continue to dominate Instagram, as they do on Facebook, highlighting their efficiency in driving engagement and demonstrating their appeal among the university's social media audience.

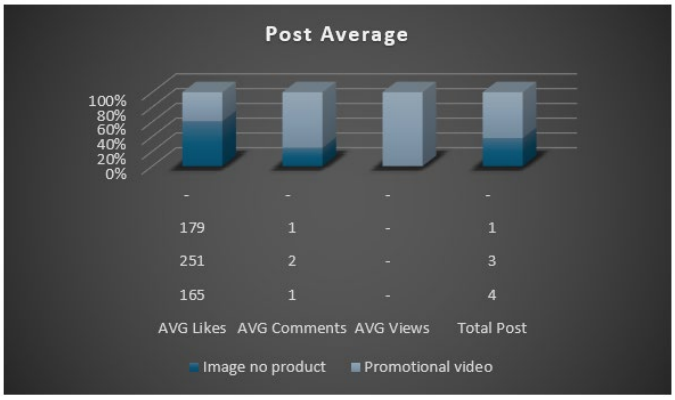


Figure B.5: WSU Instagram averages (2024)

Differences and Similarities

OSU and WSU's social media engagement tactics differ while also sharing similarities. The strength of OSU on Facebook is non-promotional picture posts, whereas WSU thrives at promotional image posts. Furthermore, OSU's promotional videos have a wider reach across platforms, whereas WSU's key engagement driver is promotional image posts. There are small differences in day and time preferences, with OSU favoring Sundays and nights and WSU finding Sundays and 7 p.m. to be the most engaging. Despite these contrasts, both universities have had success with some forms of material, such as non-promotional images on Facebook and promotional videos on Instagram. Both institutions understand the significance of timing, since daily and time trends in involvement are noted. Furthermore, promotional videos have continuously proven effective for both OSU and WSU across several platforms, demonstrating their importance in increasing audience engagement.

What kind of posts do better for competitors and WSU? What kind of posts do worse for competitors and WSU? Are there differences and/or similarities?

Types of Posts Performing Better

Promotional videos at The Ohio State University (OSU) received a lot of attention, indicating how popular they are among audiences. This shows that dynamic visual content is well received by the OSU audiences. Furthermore, OSU had substantial success with non-promotional image postings on Facebook, demonstrating the effectiveness of visually appealing content in catching audience attention and driving engagement. These findings highlight the necessity of using a variety of content formats to effectively connect with an audience and increase interaction on social media platforms.

Wright State University (WSU) had significant engagement with promotional image posts, demonstrating the power of well-crafted visual messages to resonate with their audience. This shows that images, which may be accompanied by links, have a strong appeal for WSU's audience, resulting in interaction and engagement. Furthermore, like its competitors, WSU identified promotional videos as a key source of interaction on Instagram. These videos drew attention with high likes, comments, and views, demonstrating their success in engaging WSU's audience and highlighting the necessity of using dynamic visual content across social media platforms.

Types of Posts Performing Worse

OSU reported lower engagement for non-promotional blog posts, suggesting that lengthy written content may not capture as much attention as visually appealing or concise content.

WSU noted that posts featuring just the product indoors did not perform well on Instagram. This indicates that audience engagement may require more context or diversity in content.

Differences and Similarities

OSU succeeds at non-promotional picture posts, whereas WSU shines at promotional image posts. OSU has difficulty with non-promotional blog postings, but WSU struggles with "Just Product Indoor" content. Both universities understand the value of promotional videos, which have a wide appeal among their social media audiences. Furthermore, they recognize that visual material performs better overall.

How does engagement vary across WSU and its competitors?

According to the data gathered over the last 30 days, Ohio State University has more engagement than Wright State University on both Facebook and Instagram. As previously stated, Instagram reels helped put the viewer count into perspective. While WSU averaged around 1,999 views per reel, OSU averaged 53,995 views per reel (Figure C.1).

Wright State University

Post Average	AVG Likes	AVG Comments	AVG Views	Total Post
People indoor with product	165	1	-	4
People outdoor with product	251	2	-	3
Just product indoor	179	1	-	1
Just product outdoor	-	-	-	-
Image no product	297	1	-	8
Promotional video	191	3	1,999	13

The Ohio State University

Post Average	AVG Likes	AVG Comments	AVG Views	Total Post
People indoor with product	-	-	-	-
People outdoor with product	4,988	24	-	1
Just product indoor	-	-	-	-
Just product outdoor	3,822	2	-	2
Image no product	3,684	9	-	4
Promotional video	4,661	61	53,995	12

Figure C.1: WSU and OSU Instagram averages over the last 30 days (2024)

The number of likes varied depending on the content that was posted. Both universities averaged more likes when it came to content that was more personal to the students such as promotions, campus life, student interviews, school spirit, etc. All these posts seem to evoke some sort of emotional reaction which lead to more likes, shares, and comments.

The frequency at which both schools posted varied. On average, WSU posted more than OSU. Over the last 30 days, WSU had 29 posts on Instagram while OSU had 19 (Figure C.1). On Facebook, OSU posted 23 posts and WSU posted almost double the amount with 43 posts (Figure C.2).

Wright State University

Compare categories	Total Likes	Shares	Comments	Views	Total Post
Image non promotional with link	197	9	4	0	2
Image promotional with link	471	30	17	318	25
Image non promotional no link	62	0	1	61	6
Blog post promotional	15	1	0	0	1
Blog post non promotional	0	0	0	0	0
Promotional video	73	13	0	654	9

Ohio State University

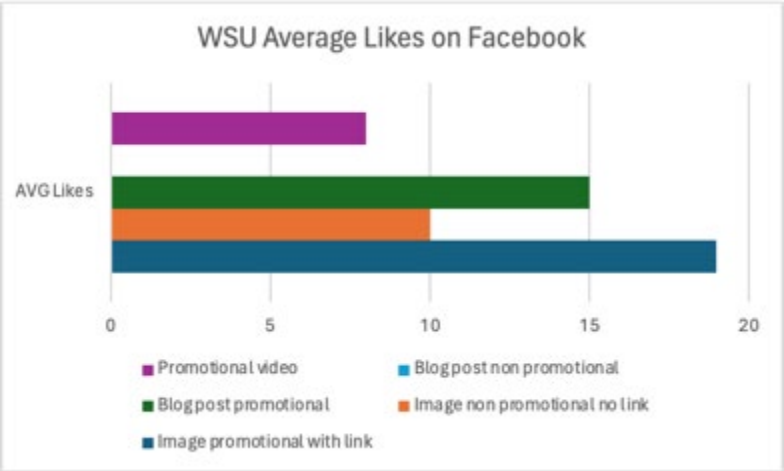
Compare categories	Total Likes	Shares	Comments	Views	Total Post
Image non promotional with link	379	18	34	0	2
Image promotional with link	479	29	47	0	6
Image non promotional no link	1925	95	215	0	6
Blog post promotional	599	33	111	0	5
Blog post non promotional	26	4	0	0	1
Promotional video	996	85	32	8400	3

Figure C.2: WSU and OSU Facebook totals over the last 30 days (2024)

In Figure C.1 we can see that in the first 24 hours of posting, the average likes for Instagram varied greatly between the two universities. Depending on the type of content that was posted, OSU averaged between 3,500 and 5,000 likes while WSU only averaged between 150 and 300 likes. The same can be seen on Facebook with OSU averaging between 20 and 250 likes while WSU only averaged between 0 and 100 likes per post (Figure C.3). The number of comments and shares each university received was dependent on the type of content that was posted, but OSU still outperformed WSU on both platforms. WSU averaged close to 0 comments and shares on both platforms while OSU averaged between 0 and 60. These findings are shown in Figure C.1 and Figure C.3. The times and frequency at which each university posted on Facebook and Instagram varied, but due to OSU's large following and their large student body, it seems that even though they posted less it did not change the fact that they would receive more engagement on their posts.

Wright State University

Post Average	AVG Likes	AVG Shares	AVG Comments
Image non promotional with link	99	5	2
Image promotional with link	19	1	1
Image non promotional no link	10	0	0
Blog post promotional	15	1	0
Blog post non promotional	0	0	0
Promotional video	8	1	0



Ohio State University

Post Average	AVG Likes	AVG Shares	AVG Comments
Image non promotional with link	190	9	17
Image promotional with link	80	5	8
Image non promotional no link	321	16	36
Blog post promotional	120	7	22
Blog post non promotional	26	4	0
Promotional video	332	28	11

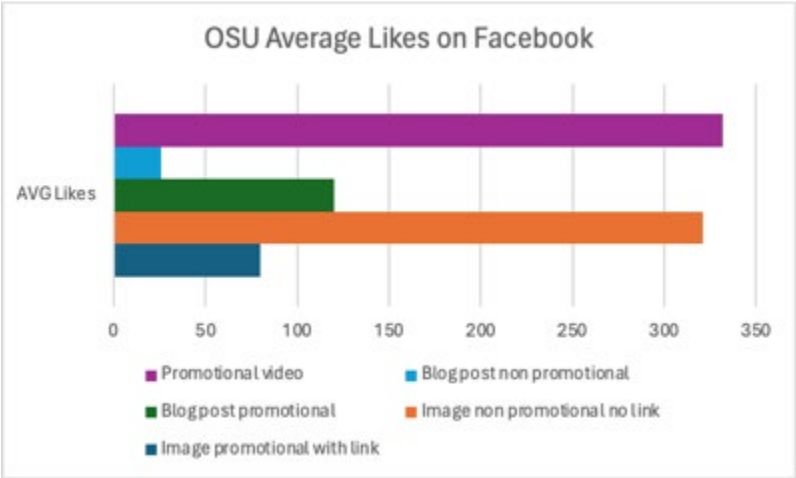


Figure C.3: WSU and OSU Facebook averages over the last 30 days. (2024)

Any additional insights when comparing WSU and competitor posts?

When we examined Ohio State University posts, both Facebook and Instagram, some posts had more likes compared to others. One of the videos being promotional got 4988 likes and more members shared among themselves on Instagram as observed in fig D.1 and fig D.2. The reel

covered the Ohio union which could be a commonality among a lot of viewers. On the other hand, the Instagram posts which were non-promotional received more likes than other posts because in fig D.3, if you notice there is some wit added to the post. Out of all, a post, fig D.4 with nostalgic touch got 11,624 likes within a day which had so much emotion added to it.

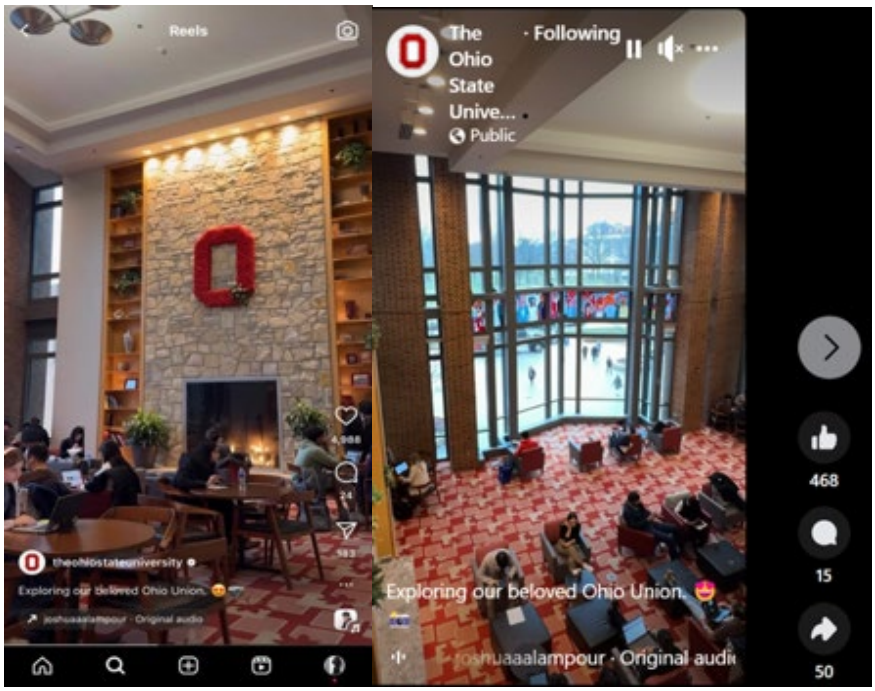


Figure D.1 & D.2: Post Displaying Ohio Union on Facebook and Instagram (2024)

Figure D.3: Witty post.

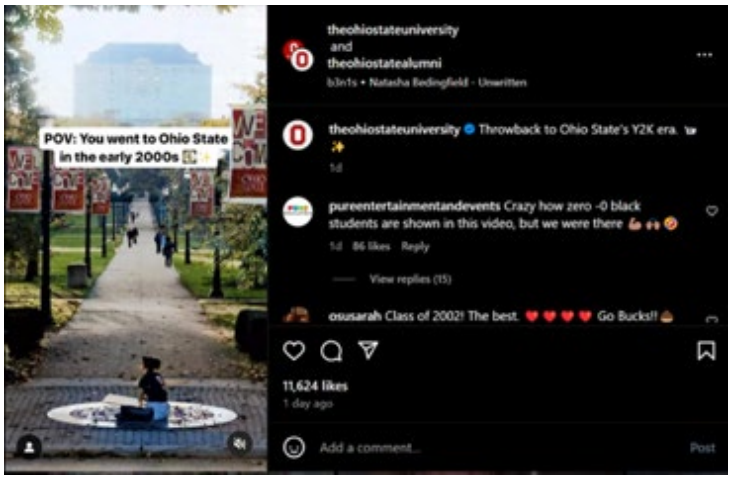


Figure D.4: Nostalgic Post

Since Wright State University posts have lesser audiences, the likes, shares, and views are comparatively lower than the Ohio State University's posts. Though the reach is low, the likes for some posts are more when compared to other posts. For example, the post with a puppy, as shown in fig D.5, received 864 likes within a few hours of posting. Another post received more likes by a simple picture of a student holding up the school flag in New York City as shown in Fig D.6. Also posts related to sports caught some attention too. Most of the time, emotional, cute, witty, and nostalgic posts performed the best in social media. Quite a few posts couldn't make it to the top because of basic reasons like the time or day of posting or simply because of the cover photo for the reels. We believe that it is not how often we post but how accurate and catchy the post must be because only certain times of the day draw the audience to view the content.

Figure D.5: Post with a pup

Figure D.6: Rowdy Raider showing flag in NYC

What suggestions going forward do you have for the content marketing manager at WSU?

Here are some additional suggestions for the content marketing manager at Wright State University:

- **Develop a Content Calendar:** Create a structured content calendar outlining upcoming events, milestones, and key themes to ensure consistency and alignment with the university's strategic goals and initiatives. This will help in planning content in advance and maintaining a steady flow of engaging posts.
- **Embrace Video Content:** Incorporate more video content into your social media strategy, including campus tours, student testimonials, faculty interviews, and event highlights.

Video content tends to be highly engaging and can help bring the Wright State experience to life for prospective students and alumni.

- **Optimize for SEO:** Ensure that your content is optimized for search engines by incorporating relevant keywords, meta descriptions, and alt tags. This will help improve the visibility of Wright State University's website and social media profiles in search engine results, driving organic traffic and brand awareness.
- **Collaborate with Departments:** Foster collaboration with various departments and units across the university to source diverse and compelling content ideas. Work closely with academic departments, student organizations, research centers, and administrative offices to showcase the breadth and depth of offerings at Wright State.
- **Utilize User-Generated Content:** Encourage students, faculty, staff, and alumni to create and share their own content about their experiences at Wright State. User-generated content not only adds authenticity but also helps in building a sense of community and pride among the university's stakeholders.
- **Monitor Trends and Adapt:** Stay updated on social media trends, platform updates, and industry best practices to refine your content strategy accordingly. Experiment with new formats, features, and trends to keep your content fresh, relevant, and engaging for your audience.
- **Invest in Paid Advertising:** Consider allocating a portion of your marketing budget towards paid social media advertising to amplify the reach and impact of your content. Utilize targeting options to reach specific demographics, geographic regions, and interest groups to maximize the effectiveness of your campaigns.

- **Measure and Analyze Performance:** Continuously monitor and analyze the performance of your content using metrics such as engagement rates, click-through rates, and conversion rates. Use these insights to identify areas for improvement, optimize your content strategy, and demonstrate the ROI of your marketing efforts.
- **Build Relationships with Influencers:** Identify and build relationships with influencers, thought leaders, and brand advocates who align with Wright State University's values and mission. Collaborate with influencers to co-create content, host events, and reach new audiences in authentic and meaningful ways.
- **Stay Authentic and Transparent:** Maintain authenticity and transparency in your communications with your audience. Be genuine, responsive, and accountable in your interactions, and always prioritize the needs and interests of your community above all else.

By implementing these suggestions, the content marketing manager at Wright State University can continue to drive engagement, build brand awareness, and foster a strong sense of community and pride among students, faculty, alumni, and other stakeholders.

What should WSU do as a result?

Wright State University can derive several actionable insights to enhance its own social media presence and strategy. Here are some recommendations for Wright State University based on the analysis of its competitor:

Identify Strengths and Weaknesses: Compare Wright State's present approach to Ohio State University's social media content strategy to determine the advantages and disadvantages of each. Determine Ohio State's strong points and opportunities for development.

Benchmark Performance Metrics: Compare Ohio State University to Wright State University's important performance metrics, including engagement rates, follower growth, and content reach. Determine any noteworthy deficiencies and prospects for enhancement.

Content Strategy Refinement: Optimize Wright State University's content strategy considering the effective components seen in Ohio State University's social media posts. This could include the kinds of information, how often they are posted, the voice they use, and the visual appeal that appeals to the audience.

Analysis of the Audience: Examine in greater detail the preferences and demographics of the social media followers of both colleges. Take inspiration from Ohio State's effective engagement strategies and modify Wright State's material to better suit the requirements and interests of its intended audience.

Creative Campaigns and Initiatives: Take ideas from Ohio State University's creative campaigns and initiatives, then modify them to suit Wright State's distinct brand identity and objectives. This could entail starting interactive marketing, holding competitions for user-generated material, or working with influencers.

Enhanced Visual Storytelling: To improve Wright State's social media storytelling skills, make an investment in the creation of high-quality visual material. Observe how Ohio State effectively engages their audience with intriguing storylines through multimedia content, including infographics, films, and live broadcasts.

Community Building and Engagement: Prioritize developing a sense of community and encouraging deep connections with Wright State's social media following. Put tactics into place to

promote user-generated material, answer messages and comments right away, and foster a feeling of community within the university's online community.

Data-Driven Optimization: Track the effects of modifications made to Wright State's social media strategy by regularly monitoring and analyzing performance data. Use analytics tools to spot patterns, evaluate the success of various content forms, and adjust long-term learnings.

Collaboration and Cross-Promotion: Seek out chances to cooperate and cross-promote with Wright State University departments, student associations, and alumni networks. To increase the university's social media presence and attract new audiences, take advantage of the aggregate reach and influence of these stakeholders.

Long-Term Strategy Alignment: Make sure that any modifications to Wright State's social media plan are in line with the institution's long-term objectives, brand identity, and more general marketing goals. Continue to assess how well social media initiatives are promoting brand exposure, student recruitment, and community engagement on campus.

By implementing these recommendations based on the analysis of Ohio State University's social media content strategy, Wright State University can strengthen its online presence, build deeper connections with its audience, and ultimately achieve greater success in its social media marketing efforts.

What did you learn from this assignment?

Our social media content analysis project, which examined Ohio State University as a competitor of Wright State University, has given us important new perspectives on the complexities of successful brand management and social media content strategy. This task gave us a thorough grasp of how important it is to evaluate performance, find industry best practices, and find areas

for improvement through competitor analysis. We discovered the importance of coordinating social media initiatives with more general marketing goals and brand identity by thoroughly analyzing Ohio State University's social media presence, content kinds, engagement strategies, and audience interactions. Additionally, this project also highlighted the significance of data-driven decision-making, since meaningful interaction and content strategy optimization depend on the analysis of key performance metrics and audience insights. All things considered, this assignment helped us better understand the challenges involved in maintaining a brand's online presence and brought to light the significance of continuous learning and adaptability in the constantly evolving field of social media marketing.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the comparison between social media posts from Wright State University and Ohio State University reveals distinct approaches to engaging their respective audiences. Wright State University emphasizes a community-centric narrative, showcasing the diverse achievements and experiences of its students, faculty, and alumni. Conversely, Ohio State University adopts a more expansive and dynamic approach, focusing on a broad range of topics including research breakthroughs, athletic accomplishments, and campus events. Despite their divergent strategies, both institutions effectively leverage social media to foster connections, promote their unique identities, and strengthen their relationships with stakeholders. Ultimately, these efforts contribute to the vibrancy and visibility of both Wright State and Ohio State University within their respective communities and beyond.

Appendix

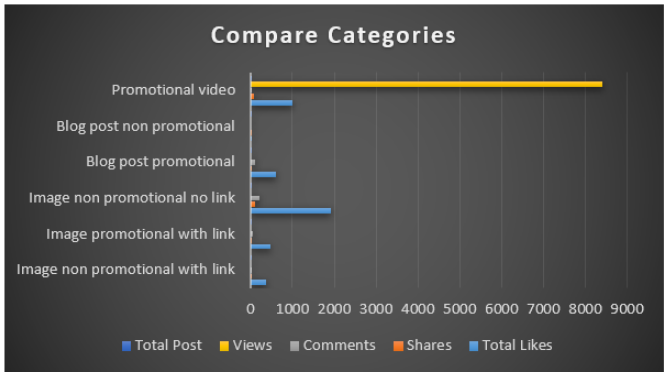


Figure A.1: OSU Facebook chart (2024)

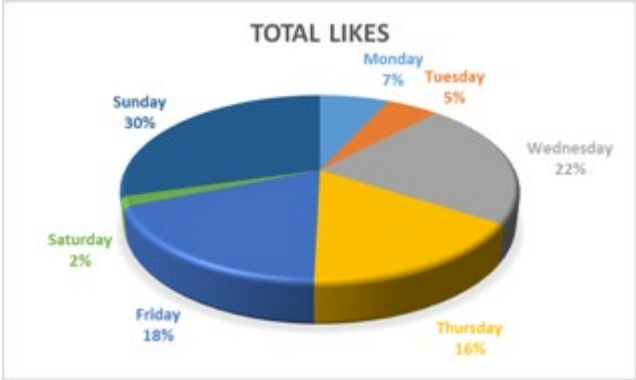
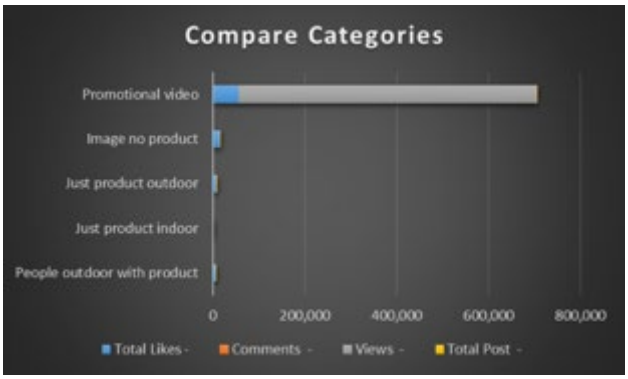


Figure A.2: OSU Facebook total daily likes (2024)

Figure A.3: OSU Facebook posting times (2024)



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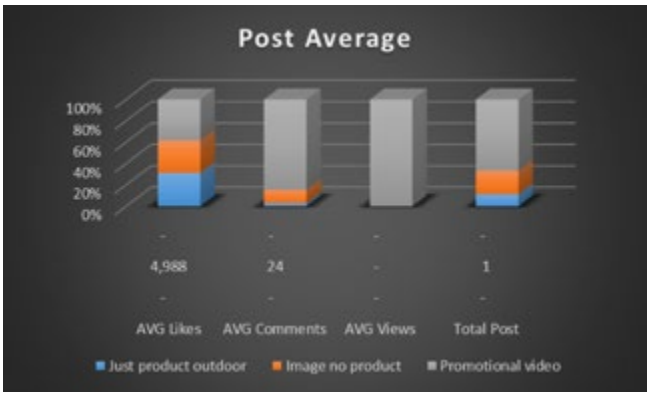

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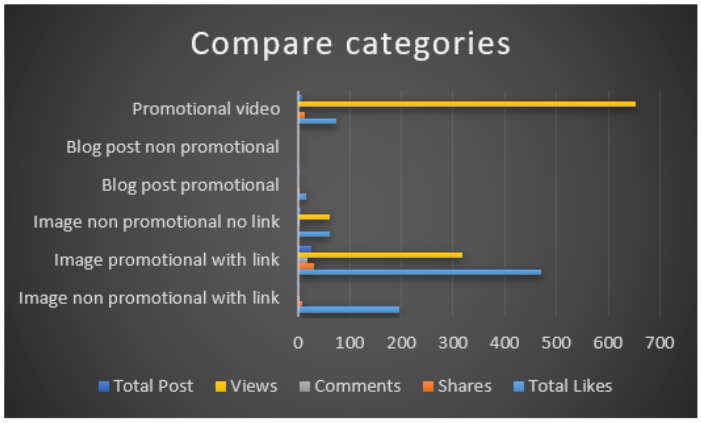

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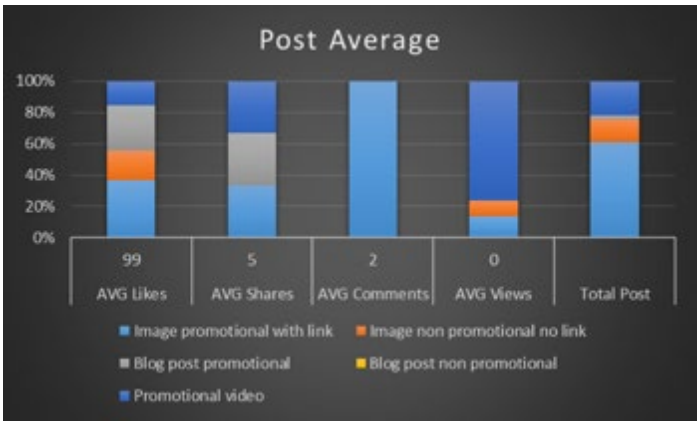


Figure B.2: WSU Facebook Averages (2024)

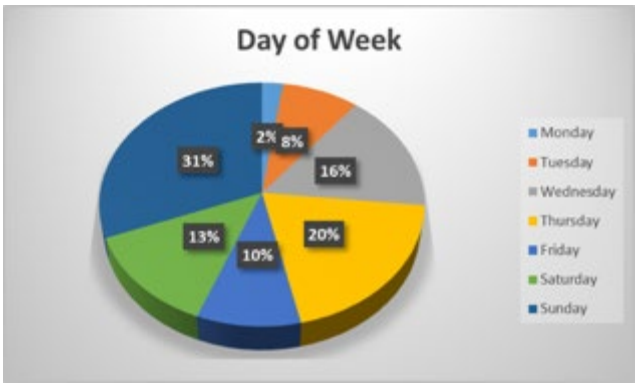


Figure B.3: WSU Facebook total daily likes (2024)

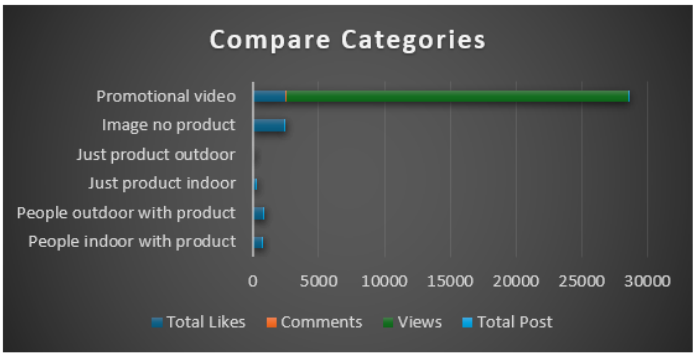


Figure B.4: WSU Instagram totals (2024)

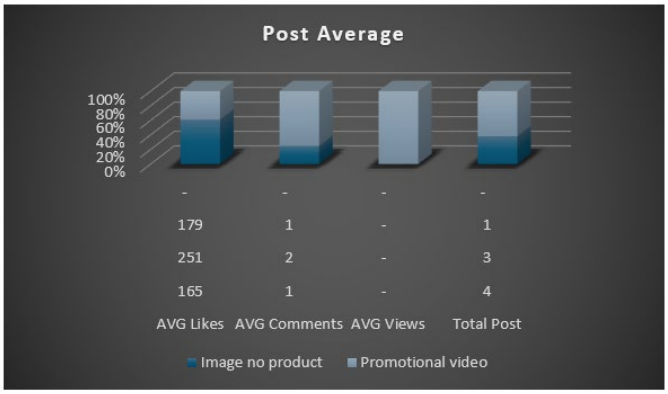


Figure B.5: WSU Instagram averages (2024)

Wright State University

Post Average	AVG Likes	AVG Comments	AVG Views	Total Post
People indoor with product	165	1	-	4
People outdoor with product	251	2	-	3
Just product indoor	179	1	-	1
Just product outdoor	-	-	-	-
Image no product	297	1	-	8
Promotional video	191	3	1,999	13

The Ohio State University

Post Average	AVG Likes	AVG Comments	AVG Views	Total Post
People indoor with product	-	-	-	-
People outdoor with product	4,988	24	-	1
Just product indoor	-	-	-	-
Just product outdoor	3,822	2	-	2
Image no product	3,684	9	-	4
Promotional video	4,661	61	53,995	12

Figure C.1: WSU and OSU Instagram averages over the last 30 days (2024)

Wright State University

Compare categories	Total Likes	Shares	Comments	Views	Total Post
Image non promotional with link	197	9	4	0	2
Image promotional with link	471	30	17	318	25
Image non promotional no link	62	0	1	61	6
Blog post promotional	15	1	0	0	1
Blog post non promotional	0	0	0	0	0
Promotional video	73	13	0	654	9

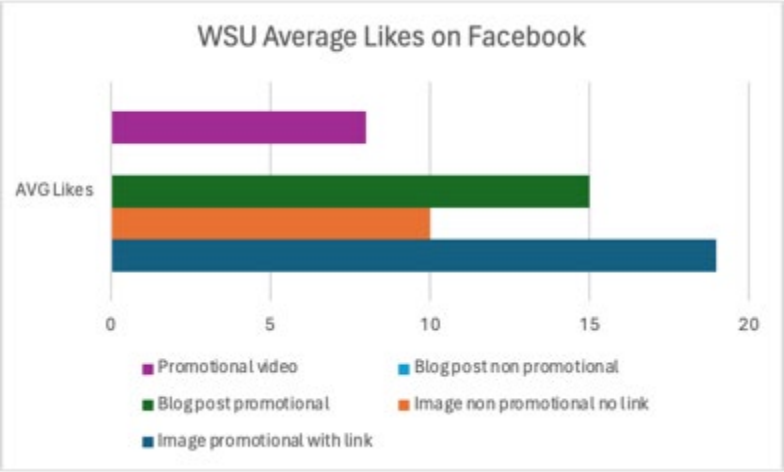
Ohio State University

Compare categories	Total Likes	Shares	Comments	Views	Total Post
Image non promotional with link	379	18	34	0	2
Image promotional with link	479	29	47	0	6
Image non promotional no link	1925	95	215	0	6
Blog post promotional	599	33	111	0	5
Blog post non promotional	26	4	0	0	1
Promotional video	996	85	32	8400	3

Figure C.2: WSU and OSU Facebook totals over the last 30 days (2024)

Wright State University

Post Average	AVG Likes	AVG Shares	AVG Comments
Image non promotional with link	99	5	2
Image promotional with link	19	1	1
Image non promotional no link	10	0	0
Blog post promotional	15	1	0
Blog post non promotional	0	0	0
Promotional video	8	1	0



Ohio State University

Post Average	AVG Likes	AVG Shares	AVG Comments
Image non promotional with link	190	9	17
Image promotional with link	80	5	8
Image non promotional no link	321	16	36
Blog post promotional	120	7	22
Blog post non promotional	26	4	0
Promotional video	332	28	11

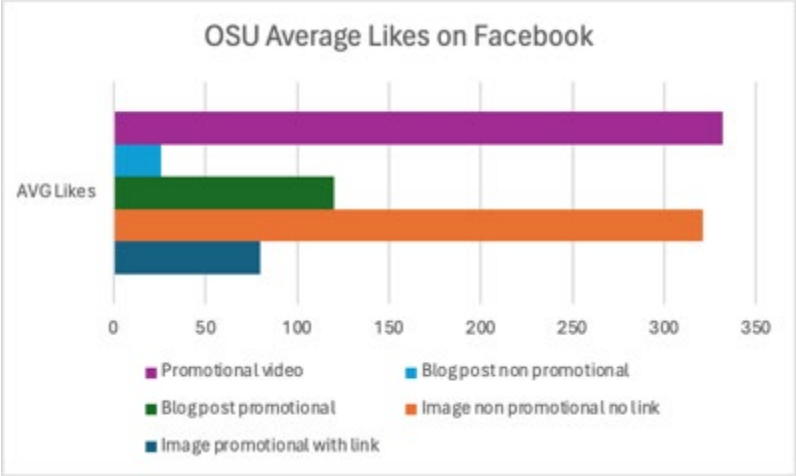


Figure C.3: WSU and OSU Facebook averages over the last 30 days. (2024)

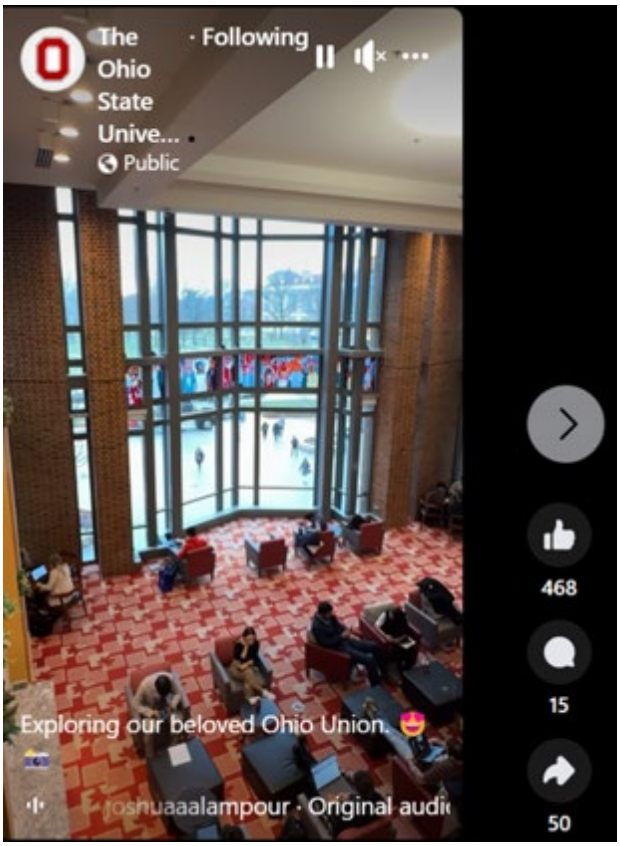


Figure D.1 & D.2: Post Displaying Ohio Union on Facebook and Instagram (2024)

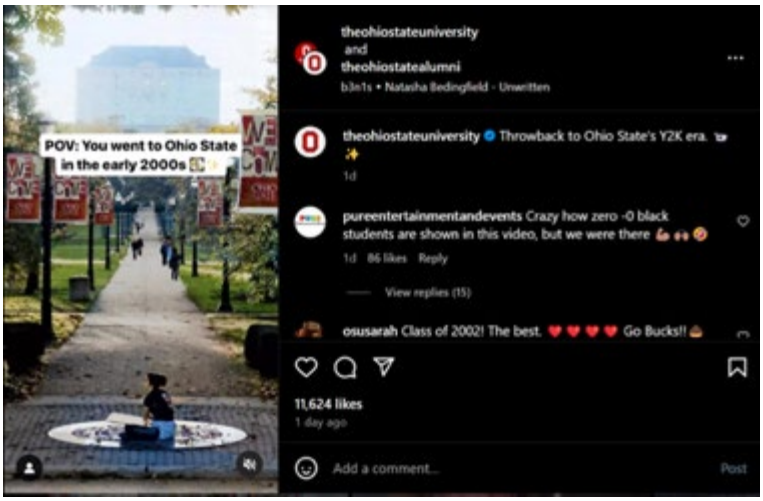


Figure D.3: Witty post (2024) **Figure D.4:** Nostalgic post (2024)

Figure D.5: Rowdy Raider with Service Animal (2024) **Figure D.6:** Student showing flag in NYC (2024)